

For ages 8 to 12

The Little Entrepreneur

A summer business story, and how to play the game





The Little Entrepreneur

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Stories about Malak, Yousef and Grandpa, and a guide to the free game.

Written for children aged 8 to 12 and the grown-ups who read with them.

Pictures: needle-felted art made for this book. Fonts: Manrope and Readex Pro (SIL Open Font Licence).

Free to print and share with family, friends and schools.

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For the grown-ups

This book has two parts. The stories follow Malak and Yousef through two summers: one with a juice stand, and one making drawings and bracelets. Each scene ends with one of Grandpa’s ideas about money: cost, price, profit, saving, stock, partners, honesty and rest.

The second part shows how to play The Little Entrepreneur, the free game the stories come from. It works in any browser and on phones, with no ads, no accounts and nothing to buy.

A good way to use it: read one scene together, talk about Grandpa’s idea, then let your child try it in the game. After each story there are activity pages, and at the end a page for planning a real tiny business.

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STORY 1 • THE JUICE STAND

Summer begins

On the first day of summer, Malak and Yousef had a plan. "Mum's birthday is at the end of summer," said Malak. "We want to buy her a real gift." Yousef emptied his pockets: 15 coins. "That's not enough," he sighed. Grandpa put down his tea. "Then let's earn the rest. What do people here want on a hot day?" "Something cold!" they shouted together.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

A business starts with something people want.



STORY 1 · 2

What does one cup cost?

Grandpa opened his old notebook. "Lemons, sugar, water and a paper cup. Let's count." They added it all up and divided it by the number of cups. "One cup costs us one coin to make," said Yousef. "That is our cost," said Grandpa. "We pay for every cup we make, even if nobody buys it."



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Cost is what you pay to make something.



STORY 1 • 3

Choosing a price

Two, 3 or 5 coins a cup? "5!" said Yousef. "More money!" Malak shook her head. "At 5, fewer people will stop. At two coins lots will come, but we only keep one coin from each cup." Grandpa smiled. "Try 3. It is fair for them, and fair for you." They wrote it on the sign in big letters: 3 coins.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

A high price brings fewer customers. A low price brings less profit per cup.



STORY 1 · 4

Market day!

On Saturday they made 12 cups. The sun was out, and so were the neighbours. By noon, 11 cups were gone. Yousef counted the coins twice: 33 coins. "We're rich!" he cheered. "Not so fast," said Grandpa. "How much did the cups cost?" "12 coins." "So what is left?"



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Counting the coins that came in is only half of the story.

Profit

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \boxed{33} & - & \boxed{12} = \boxed{21} \\ \text{coins in} & & \text{coins spent} & & \text{profit} \end{array}$$



Malak wrote it on the back of the sign. 33 coins came in. 12 coins went out. 21 coins are profit. "Profit is what's left after paying for everything," said Grandpa. Yousef put the 21 coins in the piggy bank very slowly, one by one.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Profit = coins in – coins spent.



STORY 1 • 6

A rainy Saturday

The next Saturday they made 20 cups. Then the clouds came. Only 6 people stopped, and they wanted something warm. That evening, 14 cups of juice went down the sink. "We paid for those," said Yousef quietly. "Next time," said Malak, "we look at the sky first, and make about as many as people will buy."



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Leftovers that spoil are coins thrown in the bin. Making fewer is a skill.



STORY 1 · 7

Too sour!

Uncle Saeed took one sip and made a face. "Too sour!" he said, loud enough for the whole line to hear. Yousef's cheeks went red. Malak poured a new cup with more sugar. "Can you tell us if this one is better?" He tried it, nodded, and told the line, "Now it's perfect." That afternoon they changed the recipe for good.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

A complaint is free advice.



STORY 1 · 8

6 extra coins

At closing time, the box had 6 coins too many. "The lady with the green basket paid too much," said Malak. "Nobody will know," said Yousef. Malak looked at him. Yousef sighed, and they ran after her down the street. The lady laughed. "Nobody has ever chased me to give money back!" The next Saturday she came back with two friends.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Trust is like savings: slow to build, quick to spend.



STORY 1 • 9

The stand next door

One morning a bigger boy called Karim set up a juice stand 5 steps away. Same sign, same cups, same price. "He copied us!" said Yousef. Grandpa sipped his tea. "Then ask yourselves what makes you different." Malak had an idea. She walked over and talked to Karim. Now Karim sells popcorn, they sell juice, and people buy both.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

When someone copies you, the question is: what makes you, you?



STORY 1 • 10

Too tired to count

In week 6, Malak and Yousef stayed up late making 30 cups. The next day their eyes kept closing. Yousef gave a customer 5 coins change instead of two. Malak forgot the ice. "Tired sellers make small mistakes," said Grandpa. "Rest is part of the job." So on Sunday they played football, did their homework and slept early.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Rest is part of the job.



STORY 1 • 11

The new game

The piggy bank was getting heavy. Then everyone at the summer club started talking about a new video game. It cost 30 coins. "We have enough," whispered Yousef. Malak looked at the piggy bank, then at Mum's photo on the fridge. They waited. 3 weeks later, the same game was on sale for 18 coins. They smiled, and kept saving.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Saving means picking what you want most over what you want right now.



STORY 1 · 12

The last day of summer

On the last Saturday, Yousef opened the piggy bank. They counted every coin twice: 236 coins. The gift for Mum cost 220. "We did it!" they cheered. Mum cried happy tears when she opened it. Grandpa gave them a sticker each. "You didn't just earn coins," he said. "You learned how a business works." Malak was already planning next summer.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Every coin you don't spend today walks your goal one step closer.

Grandpa's ideas

Every idea from the juice summer, in one place. In the game, each one becomes a sticker.



A business starts with something people want.



Cost is what you pay to make something.



A high price brings fewer customers. A low price brings less profit per cup.



Counting the coins that came in is only half of the story.



Profit = coins in – coins spent.



Leftovers that spoil are coins thrown in the bin. Making fewer is a skill.



A complaint is free advice.



Trust is like savings: slow to build, quick to spend.



When someone copies you, the question is: what makes you, you?



Rest is part of the job.



Saving means picking what you want most over what you want right now.



Every coin you don't spend today walks your goal one step closer.



STORY 2 · DRAWINGS AND BRACELETS

A new summer, a new idea

A year later, summer came back, and so did the plan. This time Malak and Yousef were saving for a set of storybooks: 160 coins. "No juice this year," said Malak, and held up a bracelet of round beads. Yousef held up his drawing of the street cat. "Everyone at the club asks where we got these." Grandpa smiled. "Then you already have a business. You are good at it, and people want it."



GRANDPA'S IDEA

The best business mixes what we are good at with what people want.



STORY 2 · 2

Small costs add up

"Thread costs almost nothing," said Yousef. Grandpa opened his notebook. "Let's count everything anyway." Beads, thread and a little clasp. Paper, and coloured pencils that get shorter every day. They added it all up. One bracelet cost 2 coins to make. One drawing cost 2 coins too. "Each thing is tiny on its own," said Malak, "but together they are not."



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Small costs add up. Count every one.



STORY 2 • 3

What is an hour worth?

Malak wanted to sell her bracelets for 3 coins. "I don't want to ask for too much," she said. Grandpa asked, "How long does one take?" "Almost an hour." "It costs 2 coins. At 3, a whole hour of careful work earns you one coin." Malak thought about it. At 8, very few would buy. They chose 5, and people paid it happily, because the bracelets were really good.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Good work deserves a fair price. Time and skill are worth something too.

Leftovers that wait

$$\begin{array}{|c|} \hline 30 \\ \hline \text{coins in} \\ \hline \end{array} - \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 20 \\ \hline \text{coins spent} \\ \hline \end{array} = \begin{array}{|c|} \hline 10 \\ \hline \text{profit} \\ \hline \end{array}$$



On Saturday they made 10 bracelets and sold 6, at 5 coins each. 30 coins came in. The 10 bracelets had cost 20 coins. So 10 coins were profit, and 4 bracelets were left. "Last summer the leftover juice went down the sink," said Yousef. "These don't spoil." He put the 4 bracelets in a little wooden box for next week.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Some leftovers keep. They wait in a box for the next customer.



STORY 2 · 5

The box that got too full

"If they don't spoil, let's make lots!" said Yousef. That week he made 30 bracelets, all in his favourite colour: orange. Only 5 were sold. Soon the box was full and the piggy bank was thin. Grandpa picked up the box and shook it gently by his ear. "Do you hear that? Those are 50 coins, fast asleep."



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Things waiting in a box are coins we can't spend yet.



STORY 2 · 6

Ask the customers

Malak took her notebook to the summer club. "What colours do you like? What would you buy?" Most children said teal and sand. Many asked for one special bead with their own little sign: a heart, a star, a cat. Those took longer and cost 3 coins to make, so they sold them for 8. By Saturday every one was gone.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Customers tell us what to make, if we ask them.



STORY 2 · 7

A fair split

Orders kept coming, and four hands were not enough. Their friend Hana ties the best knots on the street. "Can I help?" she asked. Before anyone threaded a single bead, Grandpa opened his notebook. "First, agree on the split." For every bracelet Hana tied, she would get one coin. They wrote it down, and all three signed.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

Partners agree on the split before the work starts.



STORY 2 · 8

The big sale

In the last week, 25 orange bracelets were still asleep in the box. "Let's sell them for 3," said Malak. "They cost 2, so we still keep one coin from each." They made a small sign that said SALE, and by noon the box was empty. They counted the piggy bank twice: 171 coins. The storybooks cost 160. Yousef drew a little orange cat inside the first book.



GRANDPA'S IDEA

A sale turns waiting stock back into coins.

Grandpa's ideas

The ideas from the bracelet summer. Which one matters most in a real business?



The best business mixes what we are good at with what people want.



Small costs add up. Count every one.



Good work deserves a fair price. Time and skill are worth something too.



Some leftovers keep. They wait in a box for the next customer.



Things waiting in a box are coins we can't spend yet.



Customers tell us what to make, if we ask them.



Partners agree on the split before the work starts.



A sale turns waiting stock back into coins.

Price it, keep it, count it

Fill this in with pencil. The answers are upside down at the bottom of the page.

1. Profit from one

THING	COST	PRICE	PROFIT
 Bracelet	2	5	
 Drawing	2	3	
 Special-bead bracelet	3	8	

2. Keeps or spoils?

 Juice ☐ keeps ☐ spoils	 Bracelet ☐ keeps ☐ spoils	 Cake ☐ keeps ☐ spoils	 Drawing ☐ keeps ☐ spoils
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3. Coins asleep in the box

 6 bracelets wait in the box. Each one cost 2 coins to make. How many coins are asleep?

Answers: 3 · 1 · 5 · spoils · keeps · spoils · 12

Your turn: plan a tiny business

Fill this in with pencil. Plan it with a grown-up, and buy supplies together.

My business idea _____

What do people want? _____

Cost to make one _____ coins

My price for one _____ coins

How many I think I can sell _____

Coins in – coins spent = profit

– =



I am saving for _____ coins

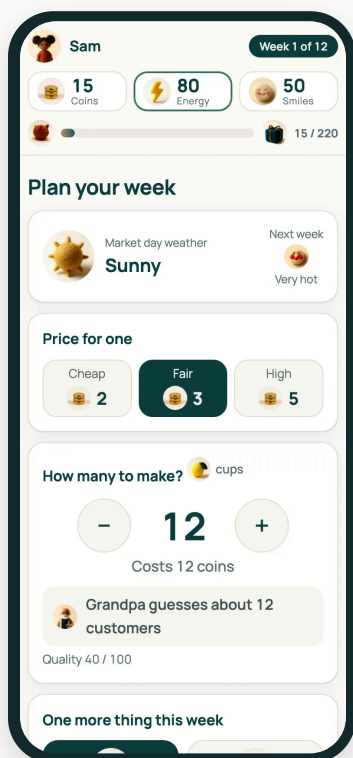


PART 2

How to play The Little Entrepreneur

In the game you run your own tiny business for a 12-week summer, just like Malak and Yousef. Pick a business, set a savings goal, and make one plan a week.

Play free at adam.ahmedhaz.com/little in any browser. It works offline once opened, in Arabic and English. A summer takes about 15 minutes.



adam.ahmedhaz.com/little

Start a summer

← Home

العربية

Your summer business

Your first name

Sam

Your name stays on this device.

Pick your picture

Pick a business

Juice stand
Fresh lemonade on hot days. Cheap to make, but it spoils.

Drawings & bracelets
Handmade and pretty. Leftovers keep for next week.

Bike wash & fix
Soap, water and a wrench. Rain keeps customers away.

Cakes & cookies
Everyone loves cake. It costs more to make, and it doesn't last.

What are you saving for?

- 1

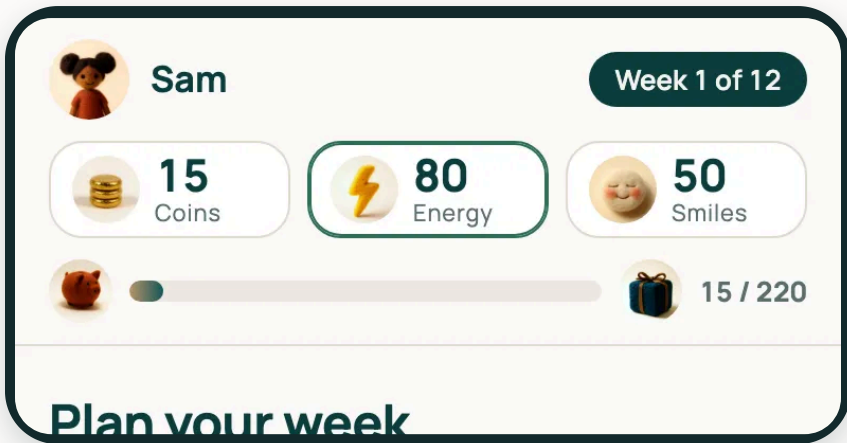
Type your first name. It stays on your device.
- 2

Pick your picture.
- 3

Pick a business: Juice stand, Drawings & bracelets, Bike wash & fix, or Cakes & cookies.
- 4

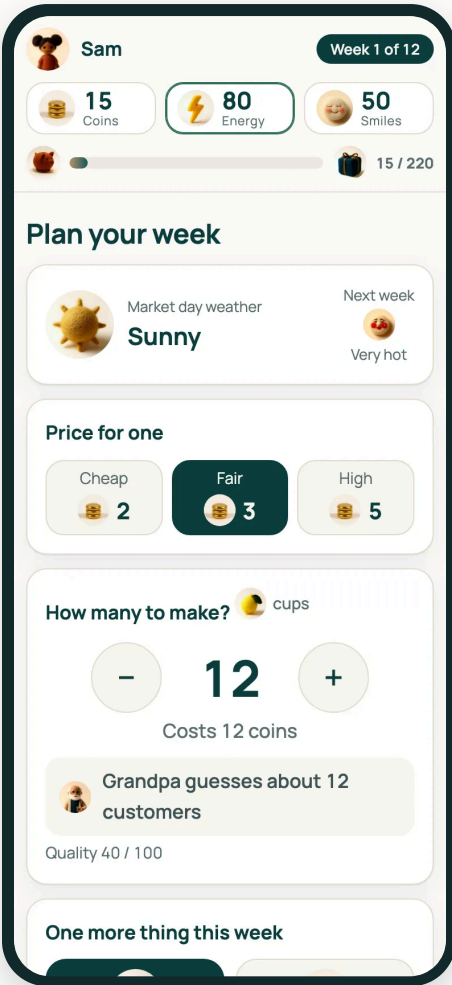
Pick a goal: a football (100), a book set (160), a gift for Mum (220) or a new bike (300).

Your three meters



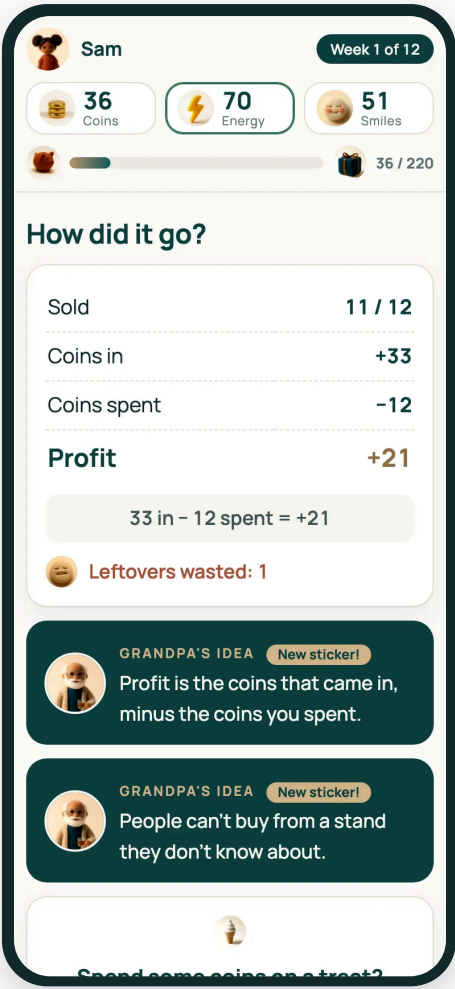
- 1 Coins: everything you have. Making things costs coins, selling brings them back.
- 2 Energy: selling and staying up late use it, rest brings it back. Under 40 you get sleepy. At 70 or more, a wise third choice opens.
- 3 Smiles: how much customers like your stand. Fair prices and good quality raise it.
- 4 The piggy bank bar shows how close you are to your goal.

Plan your week



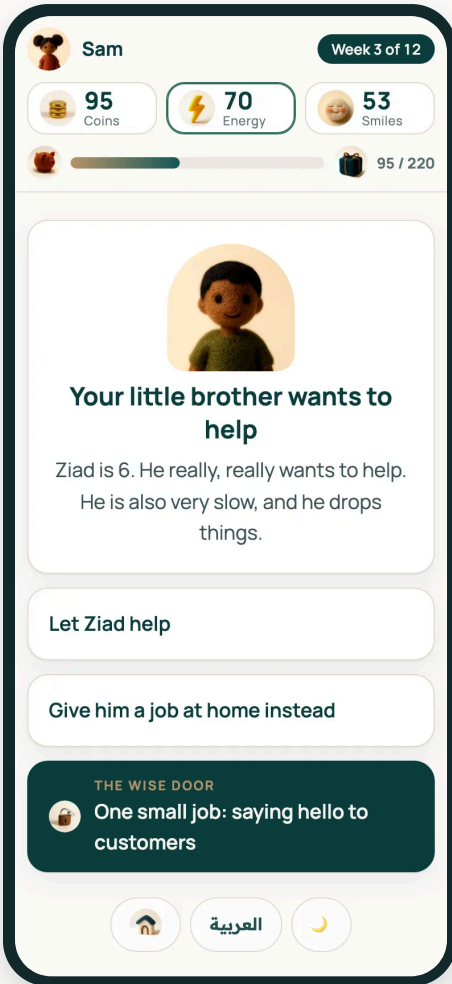
- 1 Check the market day weather. Hot days bring more juice customers, rain brings fewer.
- 2 Choose a price: cheap, fair or high.
- 3 Choose how many to make. Grandpa guesses how many customers will come.
- 4 Choose one activity: Make a poster, Practise, Study, or Rest & play.

Market day and results



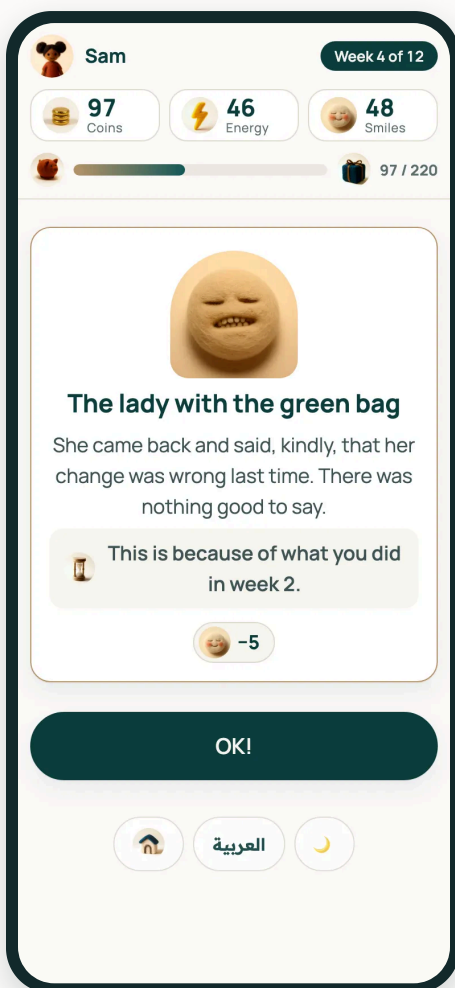
- 1 Watch the customers arrive, or tap Skip.
- 2 Read the results: coins in, coins spent, and the profit.
- 3 Juice and cakes spoil. Drawings and wash kits are kept for next week.
- 4 Spend a few coins on a treat, or save them in the piggy bank.

Dilemmas and the wise door



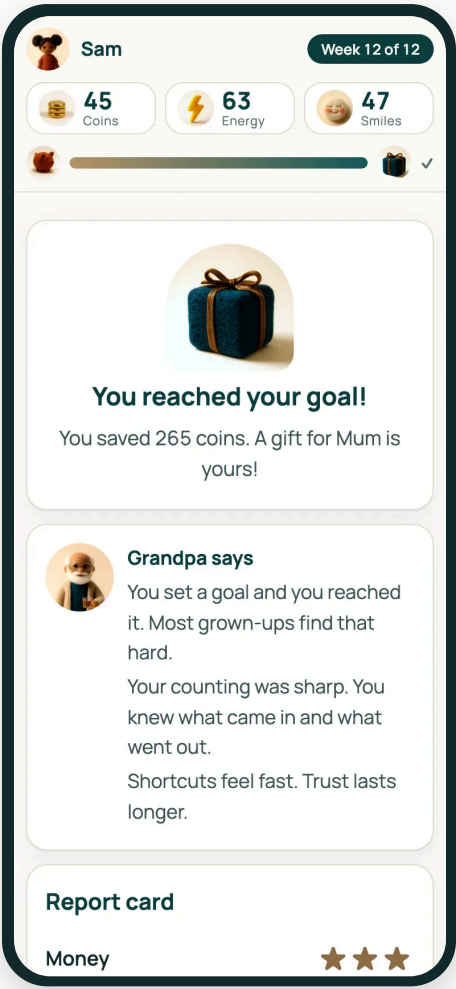
- 1 Most weeks bring a small dilemma with two fair answers. Each one costs something.
- 2 With 70 energy or more, a third door opens: the wise door.
- 3 After each choice, Grandpa shares an idea, and it goes into your sticker book.

Echoes, homework and sleepy days



- 1 Some choices come back weeks later, with the week they came from.
- 2 Study at least once every 3 weeks, or Mum or Dad closes the stand for a week.
- 3 Under 40 energy, the numbers wobble and change gets miscounted. Rest fixes it.

The end of summer



- 1 Reach your goal by week 12 to win it.
- 2 Your report card gives stars for Money, Customers, Balance and Honesty.
- 3 No harsh endings. If you don't make it, Grandpa sums up what you learned and offers another summer.

The four businesses

BUSINESS	COST TO MAKE ONE	PRICES	LEFTOVERS
 Juice stand	1	2 · 3 · 5	spoil
 Drawings & bracelets	2	3 · 5 · 8	kept
 Bike wash & fix	1	2 · 3 · 5	kept
 Cakes & cookies	2	3 · 5 · 8	spoil



Grandpa’s tips for a good summer

- Make about as many as Grandpa guesses.
- A fair price is a good place to start.
- Rest before energy drops under 40.
- Study at least once every 3 weeks.
- Treats are fine. Just not every week.

Words to know



Cost

What you pay to make something.



Price

What a customer pays you for it.



Profit

Coins in minus coins spent.



Customer

Someone who buys from you.



Leftovers

Things you made but didn't sell.



Stock

Things that keep, waiting to be sold.



Saving

Keeping coins now for something bigger later.



Investing

Spending coins on something that helps you earn more.



Partner

Someone who shares the work and the profit.

Two summers, two tiny businesses. With a juice stand, a box of beads, a notebook and Grandpa's ideas, Malak and Yousef learn what every business owner knows: cost, price, profit, stock, partners, saving and honesty.



Play the game free

adam.ahmedhaz.com/little

No ads · No accounts · Nothing to buy

